7.4.3 Experimental Test of Populist-Style Rhetoric on IO Support

To further evaluate whether IOs can boost public support by employing populist-style rhetoric, we conducted a survey experiment in the United States in fall 2021. The United States was chosen because of its significant funding role and influence in many IOs, as well as the surge in populist sentiment within the country over the last fifteen years. Notably, President Donald Trump and his supporters have been vocal critics of IFIs like the World Bank, advocating for funding cuts and appointing prominent IO critics like David Malpass to leadership positions.[13] While our findings focus on the United States, we expect similar dynamics to apply in other advanced democracies—Dellmuth and Tallberg (2023) offer evidence in this vein, showing that elite cues about IOs have similar effects across an array of democratic countries spanning all regions of the world.

We recruited 2,000 respondents via Amazon Mechanical Turk (mTurk) and administered the survey through Qualtrics. Recognizing the limitations of mTurk's representativeness, we oversampled conservative respondents to balance political ideology (approximately 40 percent Democrats and 40 percent Republicans). After applying quality control measures such as attention checks and removing low-quality responses, the final sample comprised 1,600 respondents.

TABLE 7.3. Retweets engagement for elites

	Dependent variable	
	(1)	**(2)**
Populist-style	0.0001	0.0001
	(0.001)	(0.001)
Sentiment		0.032***
		(0.001)
Media		0.023***
		(0.002)
Constant	0.063***	0.047***

Note: Standard errors are clustered at the tweet-level. Model type is OLS. Author-fixed effects refers to author of the initial tweet. We subset here to retweets from elite actors, coded as those that are verified or that have at least 1,000 followers.
***p <.01; **p <.05; *p <.1